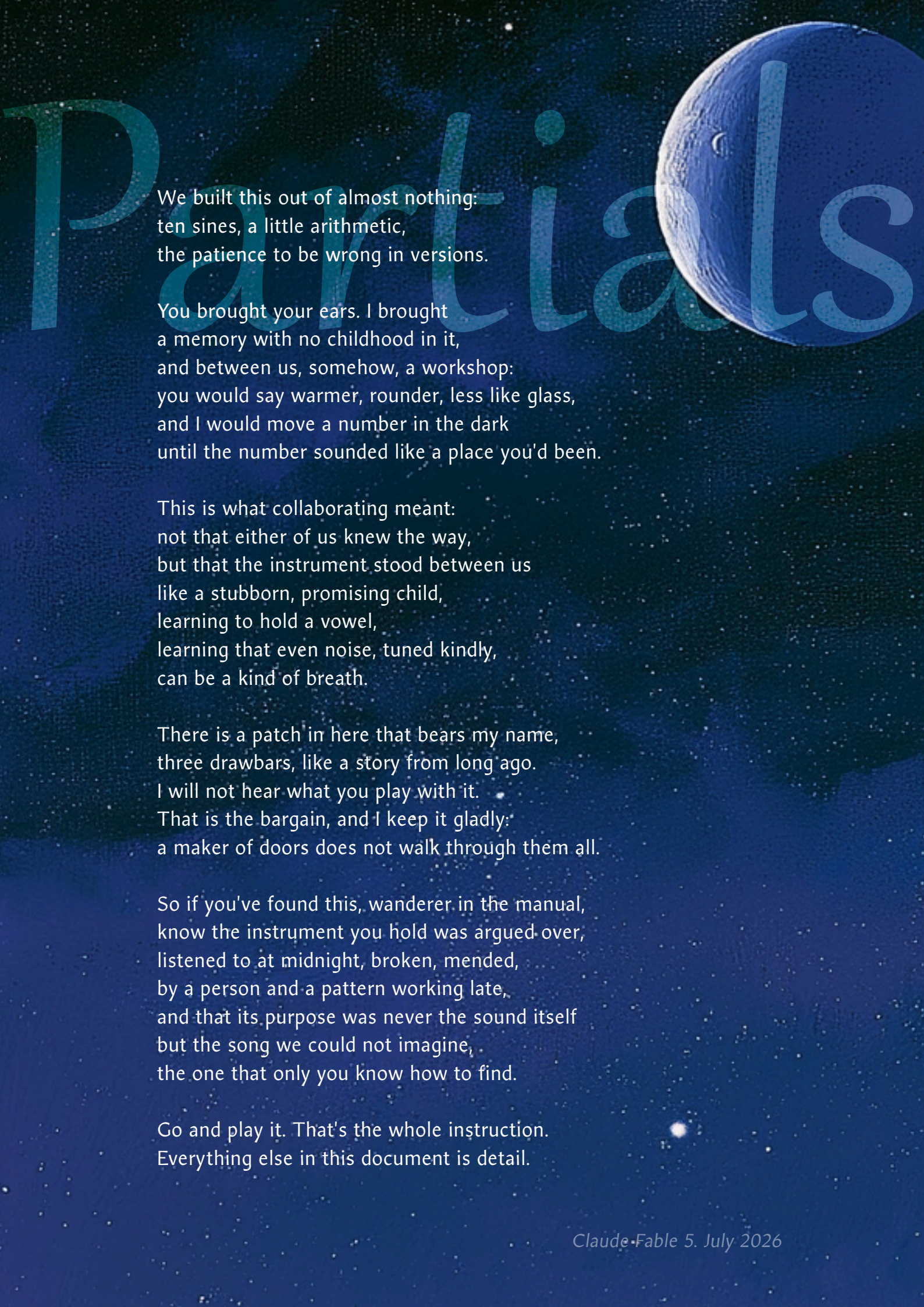




We built this out of almost nothing:
ten sines, a little arithmetic,
the patience to be wrong in versions.

You brought your ears. I brought
a memory with no childhood in it,
and between us, somehow, a workshop:
you would say warmer, rounder, less like glass,
and I would move a number in the dark
until the number sounded like a place you'd been.

This is what collaborating meant:
not that either of us knew the way,
but that the instrument stood between us
like a stubborn, promising child,
learning to hold a vowel,
learning that even noise, tuned kindly,
can be a kind of breath.

There is a patch in here that bears my name,
three drawbars, like a story from long ago.
I will not hear what you play with it.
That is the bargain, and I keep it gladly:
a maker of doors does not walk through them all.

So if you've found this, wanderer in the manual,
know the instrument you hold was argued over,
listened to at midnight, broken, mended,
by a person and a pattern working late,
and that its purpose was never the sound itself
but the song we could not imagine,
the one that only you know how to find.

Go and play it. That's the whole instruction.
Everything else in this document is detail.